

# Low-lying quasinormal modes of Kazakov–Solodukhin black holes from Chebyshev and continued-fraction methods

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**Abstract.** We calculate the low-lying quasinormal-mode (QNM) spectrum of the Kazakov–Solodukhin (KS) geometry using Chebyshev collocation and a collocation-independent Frobenius continued fraction. Generalized-eigenvalue roots are retained only when they survive tests based on singular-value residuals, spectral convergence, continuation in  $a/M$ , polynomial backward error, and the continued-fraction calculation. In the Schwarzschild limit, the  $N = 96$  scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  result and the continued-fraction value differ from the published benchmark by  $5.60 \times 10^{-11}$  and  $8.24 \times 10^{-13}$ , respectively. At fixed mass, increasing the KS deformation from  $a/M = 0$  to 1 lowers both the oscillation frequency and the damping rate of the scalar fundamental modes. For  $\ell = 2, n = 0$ , the changes in  $\text{Re } \omega$ ,  $-\text{Im } \omega$ , and  $Q = \text{Re } \omega / [2(-\text{Im } \omega)]$  are  $-7.29\%$ ,  $-2.59\%$ , and  $-4.83\%$ . We report robust scalar fundamentals for  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$ , cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ , and exploratory second overtones. A finite- $N$  singular-value pseudospectrum also broadens along the scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  branch as the deformation grows. For odd-parity gravitational perturbations we derive a gauge-invariant master equation after imposing an inverse-Cowling closure on the effective KS source. The corresponding axial frequencies are conditional on this closure, since the spherically reduced KS action does not fix nonspherical quantum-source perturbations.

**Keywords.** Kazakov-Solodukhin black holes; quasinormal modes; Chebyshev spectral methods; Leaver continued fractions; spectral residual minimization; black-hole spectroscopy.

## 1 Introduction

The relaxation of a perturbed black hole is controlled by its quasinormal modes (QNMs), a discrete set of complex frequencies fixed by the background, the perturbing field, and radiative boundary conditions. The real part of a QNM frequency sets the oscillation scale, whereas its imaginary part determines decay or growth. This spectral picture links the classical stability problem to black-hole ringdown and gravitational-wave tests of compact objects [7, 8, 9, 10].

The first binary-black-hole detection made this regime observationally accessible [11]. Ringdown spectroscopy subsequently developed into a practical test of the Kerr hypothesis, with both angular harmonics and overtones entering the analysis [12, 9, 13]. Reliable spectra are therefore needed not only for Kerr black holes, but also for proposed quantum-corrected and exotic geometries whose ringdowns may depart from the general-relativistic expectation [10, 31].

QNM frequencies are obtained with several complementary tools. WKB approximations connect the spectrum to the height and curvature of the effective-potential barrier and are efficient when the multipole number exceeds the overtone number [20, 21, 22, 23, 10]. Direct time-domain evolution extracts the least-damped modes from waveforms, while Frobenius/Leaver

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continued fractions impose the frequency-domain boundary conditions through a minimal-solution recurrence [18, 19]. The asymptotic iteration method provides another recursive treatment of the radial ordinary differential equation [24]. Spectral and pseudospectral methods discretize the boundary-value problem globally and often return many eigenvalues in a single solve [27]. Each technique has a different failure mode: WKB expansions are least reliable for low multipoles and high overtones, waveform fits favor the least-damped tones, and finite spectral pencils may contain spurious roots [23, 10, 27]. We therefore use the Chebyshev spectrum as a starting point and judge each mode with convergence, continuation, residual, and continued-fraction tests.

The background considered here is the quantum-deformed Schwarzschild metric of Kazakov and Solodukhin, obtained from a two-dimensional dilaton-gravity description of spherically symmetric quantum fluctuations [14]. Its global interpretation requires some care—the deformation improves aspects of the central geometry without generically satisfying every criterion used for a regular black hole [15]—but it provides a well-defined static metric on which wave propagation can be studied. Earlier calculations found modest changes in the fundamental QNMs and a much stronger response in parts of the overtone spectrum [16, 17]. The Schwarzschild limit then serves as a stringent numerical check, while finite  $a/M$  probes how the effective potential and its resonances respond to the quantum deformation.

QNMs are non-self-adjoint resonances, and this matters numerically. Outgoing boundary conditions lead to complex spectra that may be sensitive to both operator perturbations and discretization [31, 32]. We write the finite Chebyshev problem as  $P_N(\omega)u = 0$  and monitor  $\sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega)]$ . Equivalently,  $\sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega)] = \sqrt{\lambda_{\min}[P_N(\omega)^\dagger P_N(\omega)]}$ ; the eigenvalue itself is the square of the singular-value residual. Singular-value tests are standard tools for nonlinear eigenvalue problems [33], while related resolvent and pseudospectral diagnostics have become increasingly important in black-hole perturbation theory [31, 32]. Here they are used to decide whether a root of the generalized Chebyshev pencil is a converged KS resonance. The Frobenius calculation supplies a numerically distinct, collocation-independent discretization of the same radial equation and is particularly useful for following a mode as  $a/M$  changes [18, 17].

Our scope is the low-lying KS spectrum. The scalar  $n = 0$  fundamentals are robust fundamental modes; scalar  $n = 1$  branches are cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ ;  $n = 2$  entries are exploratory branch diagnostics; and higher overtones are outside the scope. Recent analytic-continuation methods based on confluent-Heun solutions explicitly target complete and highly damped spectra of type-D black holes [35]; the present calculation is not intended to compete in that regime. The minimally coupled scalar field gives the cleanest physical probe of the KS metric. For the axial sector we derive the gauge-invariant odd-parity equation and then impose a frozen-source, inverse-Cowling closure, as in perturbative treatments of general spherical backgrounds [2, 3, 4]. Those frequencies characterize the stated effective model, not a unique nonspherical completion of the KS quantum source.

## 1.1 Literature context and related work

### 1.1.1 Quasinormal modes and black-hole spectroscopy

The theory of black-hole perturbations begins with the Regge–Wheeler analysis of Schwarzschild perturbations [1] and early numerical recognition of damped black-hole ringing [7]. Modern reviews emphasize that QNM spectra provide information about stability, boundary conditions, late-time behavior, and possible observational tests of general relativity [8, 9, 10]. In gravitational-

wave astronomy, QNM spectroscopy is especially important because detecting multiple ringdown tones can test whether the remnant is described by the Kerr family [12, 13].

### 1.1.2 Quantum-corrected Schwarzschild geometries

Kazakov and Solodukhin proposed a quantum deformation of the Schwarzschild solution in which the radial center is displaced to a Planck-scale surface through a spherically symmetric quantum correction [14]. Later geometric analyses have clarified that the original construction improves some regularity properties but does not automatically remove all curvature singular behavior in the sense usually meant in general relativity [15]. Phenomenological work on KS black holes has studied QNMs, scattering, shadows, Hawking radiation, and overtone sensitivity [16, 17]. These studies motivate higher-accuracy spectral calculations and systematic comparisons across deformation parameters.

### 1.1.3 Spectral approaches to QNM computation

Spectral methods are attractive for QNM problems because they approximate smooth functions globally and can converge rapidly when the boundary conditions and coordinate compactifications are chosen well. Leaver’s Frobenius continued-fraction method remains a standard benchmark for black-hole QNM calculations [18]. Jansen’s QNM spectral package demonstrates how differential QNM equations can be discretized and solved as generalized eigenvalue problems over a wide class of asymptotics [27]. More recent studies by Batic, Dutykh, and collaborators use spectral formulations to revisit noncommutative Schwarzschild black holes, Lee–Wick black holes, and Morris–Thorne wormholes, correcting or sharpening conclusions obtained from lower-order approximation methods [28, 29, 30]. Pseudospectral and pseudospectrum analyses also highlight that QNM spectra can be sensitive to operator perturbations, an important caution for finite-resolution spectral discretizations [31]. Cao et al. recently applied this pseudospectrum perspective to a quantum-corrected Schwarzschild black hole, which is especially relevant background for the present KS calculation [32].

### 1.1.4 Residual and singular-value viewpoints

For a nonlinear spectral operator  $P(\omega)$ , an exact QNM satisfies  $P(\omega)u = 0$  for a nonzero state  $u$ . At finite resolution this condition can be tested through the smallest singular value, while  $P^\dagger P$  expresses the same defect as a positive-semidefinite Hermitian problem. Smallest-singular-value methods are well established for nonlinear eigenvalue problems [33], and closely related diagnostics occur in pseudospectral studies of non-self-adjoint black-hole operators [31, 32]. We use this viewpoint to refine the KS roots and then compare them with spectral convergence and a Leaver continued fraction [18, 27].

## 2 Methods

### 2.1 Kazakov–Solodukhin perturbation problem

Kazakov and Solodukhin obtained a spherically symmetric quantum deformation of the Schwarzschild solution by reducing the four-dimensional Einstein theory to an effective two-dimensional dilaton-gravity problem and choosing a renormalizable dilaton potential [14]. We

106 use the areal-radius form subsequently employed in the KS QNM analysis of Konoplya [16]:

$$\begin{aligned} ds^2 &= -f_a(r)dt^2 + f_a(r)^{-1}dr^2 + r^2d\Omega^2, \\ f_a(r) &= \frac{\sqrt{r^2 - a^2}}{r} - \frac{2M}{r}, \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

107 Here  $r$  is the areal radius,  $M > 0$  is the mass parameter, and  $a \geq 0$  is a length scale. No radial-  
108 coordinate transformation relative to the convention of Ref. [16] is made. In that convention  
109 the present numerical work treats  $a$  directly as the deformation parameter; no otherwise unused  
110 renormalized coupling is introduced. Reality of the metric coefficients restricts the coordinate  
111 patch to  $r \geq a$ . The outer horizon follows from  $f_a(r_h) = 0$ :

$$\sqrt{r_h^2 - a^2} = 2M, \quad r_h = \sqrt{4M^2 + a^2}. \quad (2)$$

112 Thus  $r_h > a$  for every finite  $a/M$ , and the value  $a/M = 1$  used below is not an extremal or  
113 degenerate-horizon limit; it is the upper endpoint of the deformation interval sampled in this  
114 study. Finally,  $\sqrt{r^2 - a^2}/r \rightarrow 1$  as  $a \rightarrow 0$ , so  $f_a(r) \rightarrow f_0(r) = 1 - 2M/r$  and Eq. (1) reduces  
115 directly to Schwarzschild in standard areal coordinates.

116 The first perturbation sector is a minimally coupled massless test scalar. Starting from

$$\square\Phi = \frac{1}{\sqrt{-g}}\partial_\mu(\sqrt{-g}g^{\mu\nu}\partial_\nu\Phi) = 0 \quad (3)$$

117 and separating variables according to

$$\Phi(t, r, \theta, \phi) = e^{-i\omega t}Y_{\ell m}(\theta, \phi)\frac{\Psi(r)}{r}, \quad (4)$$

118 with  $\nabla_{S^2}^2 Y_{\ell m} = -\ell(\ell + 1)Y_{\ell m}$ , gives

$$\frac{1}{r^2}\frac{d}{dr}\left[r^2 f_a(r)\frac{d}{dr}\left(\frac{\Psi}{r}\right)\right] + \left[\frac{\omega^2}{f_a(r)} - \frac{\ell(\ell + 1)}{r^2}\right]\frac{\Psi}{r} = 0. \quad (5)$$

119 Introducing the tortoise coordinate  $dr_*/dr = f_a^{-1}$  reduces this equation to the Schrödinger form

$$\frac{d^2\Psi}{dr_*^2} + [\omega^2 - V_{0\ell}(r; a)]\Psi = 0, \quad (6)$$

120 where the scalar effective potential is therefore

$$V_{0\ell}(r; a) = f_a(r)\left[\frac{\ell(\ell + 1)}{r^2} + \frac{1}{r}\frac{df_a}{dr}\right], \quad (7)$$

121 in agreement with the minimally coupled scalar equation used in Ref. [16]. QNM boundary  
122 conditions select solutions that are purely ingoing at the horizon and purely outgoing at spatial  
123 infinity. These conditions make  $\omega$  complex and the radial problem non-self-adjoint.

124 The odd-parity sector requires an assumption beyond the spherical KS background. The  
125 original KS construction explicitly writes the full metric as a nonperturbative spherically  
126 symmetric part plus small propagating nonspherical modes and treats the latter classically  
127 at leading order [14]. Motivated by that separation, we represent the quantum-corrected

spherical background through  $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi T_{\mu\nu}^{\text{eff}}$  and set the *gauge-invariant odd-parity current* of the effective source to zero. This is an additional inverse-Cowling (frozen-source) closure, not a constitutive law derived from the spherical KS effective action. It retains the KS spherical quantum backreaction but sets the odd part of  $\delta T_{\mu\nu}^{\text{eff}}$  to zero and therefore neglects independent nonspherical quantum-source excitations. The modes below are conditional on this explicitly defined model.

To display the gauge invariance, write the background as  $g_{ab}(y)dy^a dy^b + r^2(y)\gamma_{AB}dz^A dz^B$ , where  $a, b \in \{t, r\}$ , and expand an odd perturbation as

$$\delta g_{aB} = h_a X_B^{\ell m}, \quad \delta g_{AB} = h_2 X_{AB}^{\ell m}. \quad (8)$$

Under an odd infinitesimal diffeomorphism generated by  $\xi_A = \Lambda X_A^{\ell m}$ ,

$$h_a \mapsto h_a - D_a \Lambda + \frac{2D_a r}{r} \Lambda, \quad h_2 \mapsto h_2 - 2\Lambda. \quad (9)$$

With our harmonic normalization  $h_2 = 2h$ , the one-form

$$k_a = h_a - \frac{1}{2} D_a h_2 + \frac{D_a r}{r} h_2 \quad (10)$$

is therefore gauge invariant. This is Eq. (18) of Gundlach and Martínez-García [3], written in the Gerlach–Sengupta conventions of Ref. [2]. We choose the two-dimensional volume form so that  $\epsilon^{tr} = +1$  in the static  $(t, r)$  chart and define, as in Eq. (68) of Ref. [3],

$$\Pi = \epsilon^{ab} D_b \left( \frac{k_a}{r^2} \right). \quad (11)$$

Writing the odd stress perturbation as  $\delta T_{aB} = \delta t_a^{\text{odd}} X_B$ , its gauge-invariant source one-form is  $L_a = \delta t_a^{\text{odd}} - Q_{\text{bg}} h_a$ , where  $Q_{\text{bg}}$  denotes the coefficient called  $Q$  for the angular background stress tensor in the notation of Ref. [3]; this is their Eq. (19). Because it is constructed from the gauge-invariant matter combination, imposing  $L_a = 0$  does not fix a coordinate gauge. The general sourced master equation, Eq. (69) of Ref. [3], is

$$D_a \left[ \frac{1}{r^2} D^a (r^4 \Pi) \right] - (\ell - 1)(\ell + 2) \Pi = -16\pi \epsilon^{ab} D_b L_a. \quad (12)$$

The associated conservation law is  $D_a (r^2 L^a) = (\ell - 1)(\ell + 2) L$ , Eq. (62) of the same reference. Our inverse-Cowling closure sets both odd source amplitudes  $L_a = L = 0$ , so the conservation equation and the right-hand side of Eq. (12) vanish identically. Equivalently, Karlovini's Eqs. (38), (39), and (46) give  $(D^a D_a - U)\psi = \kappa r \epsilon^{ab} D_a (r^{-2} J_b)$ , with the same source-free reduction [4].

For the static metric used here, the normalization  $\Psi_{\text{ax}} = r^3 \Pi$  (up to an irrelevant constant) and  $dr_*/dr = f_a^{-1}$  remove the first radial derivative from the source-free equation. After Fourier decomposition with  $e^{-i\omega t}$ , it becomes

$$\frac{d^2 \Psi_{\text{ax}}}{dr_*^2} + [\omega^2 - V_{\text{ax},\ell}(r; a)] \Psi_{\text{ax}} = 0, \quad (13)$$

with the general anisotropic-source potential

$$V_{\text{ax},\ell} = f_a \left[ \frac{\ell(\ell + 1)}{r^2} - \frac{6m(r)}{r^3} + 4\pi(\rho - p_r) \right], \quad f_a = 1 - \frac{2m(r)}{r}. \quad (14)$$

This form is also obtained in the inverse-Cowling treatment of general static spherical backgrounds [Eqs. (14)–(17) of Ref. [5]].

For the KS metric,  $g_{tt}g_{rr} = -1$ . The background Einstein identities give

$$m(r) = \frac{r}{2} (1 - f_a) = M + \frac{r - \sqrt{r^2 - a^2}}{2}, \quad 4\pi\rho = \frac{m'}{r^2}, \quad p_r = -\rho. \quad (15)$$

Substitution into Eq. (14) yields the gauge-invariant inverse-Cowling KS axial potential used in all calculations:

$$V_{\text{ax},\ell}(r; a) = f_a(r) \left[ \frac{\ell(\ell+1)}{r^2} + \frac{2(f_a - 1)}{r^2} - \frac{f'_a}{r} \right]. \quad (16)$$

At  $a = 0$ ,  $m = M$ ,  $\rho = p_r = 0$ , and Eq. (16) becomes the Schwarzschild Regge–Wheeler potential [1]. For comparison, define the lapse-substitution potential

$$V_{\text{lapse},\ell}(r; a) = f_a(r) \left[ \frac{\ell(\ell+1)}{r^2} - \frac{6M}{r^3} \right]. \quad (17)$$

For  $a > 0$ , the inverse-Cowling potential differs from this comparison potential by

$$\Delta V_{\text{ax}} = \frac{f_a}{r^3} \left[ 2(\sqrt{r^2 - a^2} - r) - \frac{a^2}{\sqrt{r^2 - a^2}} \right], \quad (18)$$

so the two models are not equivalent. The same effective-source potential is also used in the public high-precision Chebyshev calculation of Batic, Dutykh, and Sukaiti [6]; Section 3 compares overlapping modes directly. We use this potential to compute the low-lying spectrum with two numerically distinct radial discretizations, monitoring residuals, backward error, continuation in  $a/M$ , and local pseudospectral sensitivity. Gauge invariance removes coordinate artifacts from the metric master variable; it does not make the inverse-Cowling closure unique. A nonspherical quantum-source action could instead generate a nonzero right-hand side or additional couplings in Eq. (12) [2, 3, 4].

## 2.2 Numerical method

We solve the radial problem in two complementary ways. A time-domain evolution of the scalar equation provides a quick check on the sign and scale of the frequency shift, following the strategy used in earlier KS studies [16]. The quantitative spectrum comes from a direct Chebyshev discretization of the factored frequency-domain equation [27]. The matrix-pencil fit to the waveform is therefore a diagnostic, not the operator from which the tabulated QNMs are obtained.

### 2.2.1 Baseline time-domain diagnostic

The baseline evolves the radial wave equation in tortoise coordinate  $x = r_*$ ,

$$\frac{\partial^2 \Psi}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial^2 \Psi}{\partial x^2} + V_{0\ell}(r(x); a) \Psi = 0. \quad (19)$$

For orientation, Eq. (19) is evolved on  $x/M \in [-250, 500]$ , with  $\Delta x = 0.1M$ ,  $\Delta t = 0.05M$ ,  $t_{\text{max}} = 320M$ , and observation point  $x_{\text{obs}} = 20M$ . A Gaussian pulse  $\Psi(0, x) = \exp[-(x/4M)^2]$  is evolved with first-order outgoing boundary conditions, as in standard time-domain QNM extractions [25, 10, 16]. The interval  $60M \leq t \leq 160M$  is fitted by

$$\Psi_{\text{fit}}(t) = Ae^{-\alpha(t-t_0)} \cos(\omega_R t + \phi) + C_0, \quad \omega_{\text{fit}} = \omega_R - i\alpha.$$

A rank-four matrix-pencil reduction is also applied to the same waveform [26]. It recovers the expected ringdown scale and deformation trend, but no frequency reported as a spectral result is inferred from this fit.

### 2.2.2 Chebyshev spectral discretization

The direct spectral method compactifies the horizon-to-infinity domain with

$$s = 1 - \frac{r_h}{r}, \quad x = 2s - 1, \quad x \in [-1, 1],$$

where  $r_h = \sqrt{4M^2 + a^2}$ . Chebyshev-Gauss collocation points

$$x_j = \cos\left(\frac{\pi(j + 1/2)}{N}\right), \quad j = 0, \dots, N - 1,$$

are mapped to  $s_j = (x_j + 1)/2$ , excluding the two singular endpoints. Barycentric differentiation matrices  $D$  and  $D^2$  approximate  $\partial_s$  and  $\partial_s^2$ , following the usual pseudospectral treatment of QNM boundary-value problems [27].

The QNM boundary behavior is imposed analytically by factoring

$$\Psi(r) = e^{i\omega r} r^{2iM\omega} s^{-i\omega/f'_a(r_h)} u(s). \quad (20)$$

The factorization in Eq. (20) builds the outgoing behavior at infinity and the ingoing behavior at the horizon into the unknown, leaving  $u(s)$  regular on the collocation grid [18, 27]. Substitution into Eq. (6) gives the quadratic eigenvalue problem

$$P_N(\omega) \mathbf{u} \equiv \left( A_0 + \omega A_1 + \omega^2 A_2 \right) \mathbf{u} = 0. \quad (21)$$

The matrices  $A_0, A_1, A_2$  are built directly from  $f_a(r)$ ,  $f'_a(r)$ , the selected potential  $V_{0\ell}$  or  $V_{\text{ax},\ell}$ , and the chain-rule factors relating  $r$  and  $s$ .

### 2.2.3 Residual test and mode selection

For a trial frequency we evaluate the residual map

$$\omega \mapsto \sigma_{\min}(P_N(\omega)),$$

where  $P_N(\omega)$  is the finite-dimensional Chebyshev representation of the factored radial equation. A true finite-dimensional eigenfrequency drives this singular value to zero; in floating-point arithmetic a well-resolved mode appears as a sharp local minimum. This is the same singular-value viewpoint used in nonlinear eigenvalue analysis and black-hole pseudospectra [33, 31, 32].

The quadratic pencil first supplies possible roots in a damped frequency window. We then minimize  $\sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega)]$  locally, compare the mode across several values of  $N$ , follow it continuously in  $a/M$ , and solve the corresponding Frobenius recurrence. The tables report the frequency together with the raw residual, a scale-aware polynomial backward error, and the branch classification. In this way the generalized eigensolve locates the resonance, while convergence and the continued fraction determine how much confidence can be attached to it [18, 27].



## 2.2.4 Generalized eigenproblem and residual

Equation (21) is linearized as

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & I \\ -A_0 & -A_1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{u} \\ \omega \mathbf{u} \end{pmatrix} = \omega \begin{pmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & A_2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{u} \\ \omega \mathbf{u} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (22)$$

We solve Eq. (22) with `scipy.linalg.eig`. Its roots are initial guesses rather than final frequencies, since polynomial linearizations can magnify scaling and conditioning problems. The scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamental is identified from the Schwarzschild spectrum, whereas overtones are followed by continuity of both frequency and eigenfunction and are checked separately with the continued fraction [18, 27].

## 2.2.5 Root filtering, refinement, and branch assignment

The selection rules are fixed before the spectrum is computed. Before solving the pencil, each row of the pair of linearized matrices is divided by the larger of its two row infinity norms; the same operation is then applied columnwise after row scaling. Scaling factors are clipped to  $[10^{-100}, 10^{100}]$ , and the right generalized eigenvectors are mapped back to the unscaled coordinates. Infinite and non-finite roots are removed. The physical search window is  $0.05 < \text{Re } \omega < 2$  and  $-3 < \text{Im } \omega < -0.02$ . Roots separated by at most  $10^{-7}$  are treated as one numerical cluster, retaining the representative with the smaller raw-polynomial singular-value residual. At most the 20 candidates closest to the current branch target enter the detailed scoring stage.

For a previously tracked branch, a candidate must lie within an absolute complex-frequency distance 0.20 of the preceding target. Competing matches minimize

$$S = d_{\text{target}} + 0.45d_{\text{cont}} + 0.35(1 - |\langle u_{j-1}, u_j \rangle|) + 10^{-3} \min(\sigma_j / \sigma_{\text{best}}, 100),$$

where, for the shortlisted candidate set  $C$ ,

$$d_{\text{target}} = \frac{|\omega_j - \omega_{\text{target}}|}{\max(|\omega_{\text{target}}|, 0.1)}, \quad d_{\text{cont}} = \frac{|\omega_j - \omega_{j-1}|}{\max(|\omega_{j-1}|, 0.1)}, \quad \sigma_{\text{best}} = \min_{k \in C} \sigma_k.$$

Here  $\sigma_j = \sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega_j)]$  is evaluated on the raw, unequilibrated polynomial matrices at the unrefined generalized-eigenvalue candidate. Candidate frequencies and right eigenvectors are generated from the row- and column-equilibrated linearized pencil; before overlap evaluation, the right eigenvectors are mapped back by the column-scaling matrix as  $x = D_r y$ . The extracted mode shapes are normalized, and the previous shape is barycentrically interpolated to the new grid. The absolute value in  $|\langle u_{j-1}, u_j \rangle|$  removes the arbitrary complex phase of either eigenvector. The selected raw root is refined within a rectangular radius 0.02 in each complex-frequency component by L-BFGS-B minimization of  $\sigma_{\min}^2[P_N(\omega)]$ , with at most 500 iterations, `ftol`=  $10^{-18}$ , and `gtol`=  $10^{-12}$ .

The catalogue labels  $n = 0, 1, 2$  begin from the stated Schwarzschild seeds; after each deformation value, the corresponding continued-fraction roots become the three targets for the next value, and already assigned roots are excluded within  $10^{-7}$ . A catalogue row is retained only when its raw-polynomial backward error is below  $10^{-8}$  and its spectral-continued-fraction relative difference is below  $10^{-4}$ . These thresholds remove clearly unresolved roots, but they do not by themselves establish the physical reliability of a branch. In particular, the  $n = 2$  modes remain exploratory because their convergence is visibly less uniform.



For completeness, the implemented sequence is: (1) equilibrate and solve the quadratic pencil; (2) remove non-finite roots and roots outside the damped window; (3) cluster at  $10^{-7}$ ; (4) enforce the 0.20 continuation gate and score competing matches; (5) refine the selected Chebyshev root by bounded singular-value minimization; (6) apply the backward-error and spectral-continued-fraction gates; and (7) propagate the validated continued-fraction root as the next deformation target. Thus the continued-fraction calculation is collocation-independent, although it shares the perturbation equation and endpoint factorization.

The direct spectral residual is

$$R_N(\omega) = P_N(\omega)^\dagger P_N(\omega). \quad (23)$$

Equation (23) is Hermitian and positive semidefinite up to roundoff. We quote  $\sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega)]$  and the scale-aware polynomial backward error, but neither number is meaningful in isolation: a small residual can accompany a poorly conditioned or nonconvergent discretized root [33]. Spectral-size convergence and the continued-fraction result therefore carry equal weight in the mode assignment.

### 2.2.6 Leaver-style validation

As a collocation-independent frequency-domain calculation, we also solve a Frobenius recurrence in the manner of Leaver [18, 19]. It uses the same compact coordinate  $s = 1 - r_h/r$  and the same physical endpoint behavior, but no Chebyshev grid, matrix-pencil roots, or singular-value minimization. We write

$$\Psi(r) = e^{i\omega r} r^{2iM\omega} s^{-i\omega/f'(r_h)} u(s),$$

and expand the regular factor as a Frobenius series,

$$u(s) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n s^n.$$

Substitution into the factored radial equation gives

$$B_2(s)u'' + B_1(s)u' + B_0(s)u = 0,$$

where the  $B_j(s)$  are generated by formal power-series algebra from the KS metric functions. The Taylor-truncated Frobenius equations define a multi-term recurrence for the coefficients  $a_n$ . Gaussian elimination reduces this recurrence to the three-term form

$$\alpha_n a_{n+1} + \beta_n a_n + \gamma_n a_{n-1} = 0,$$

and the minimal-solution condition is imposed through Leaver's continued fraction,

$$\beta_0 - \frac{\alpha_0 \gamma_1}{\beta_1 - \frac{\alpha_1 \gamma_2}{\beta_2 - \dots}} = 0. \quad (24)$$

The reported calculation expands each  $B_j$  through Taylor order 96 and evaluates the reduced recurrence to continued-fraction depth 240. Roots of Eq. (24) are obtained in IEEE-754 double precision by applying the MINPACK hybrid solver exposed by `scipy.optimize.root` to the real and imaginary residual components. The root tolerance is  $10^{-11}$ , the maximum number of residual-function evaluations is 1000, and the accepted residual is required to be below

$10^{-7}$  for the scalar validation calculation. The initial guesses are the branch-tracked  $N = 32$  Chebyshev candidates. At  $a/M = 0$ , those candidates are selected as the nearest distinct roots to the 18 literature targets listed in Appendix 11; no manual or continued-fraction Schwarzschild seed is used. Branch identity is maintained by continuation over  $a/M = 0, 0.2, 0.5, 1$  and by keeping the fundamental and first-overtone targets distinct. The catalogue uses the same settings, with a relaxed  $10^{-4}$  residual acceptance threshold for the most delicate second-overtone recurrence reductions. This validation layer is collocation-independent: it uses no Chebyshev grid, matrix-pencil data, or residual minimization, while sharing the same perturbation equation and endpoint factorization.

### 3 Results

#### 3.1 Schwarzschild validation

As an external benchmark we use the spin-zero Schwarzschild fundamental with  $\ell = 2$ , overtone index  $n = 0$ , mass normalization  $M = 1$ , time dependence  $e^{-i\omega t}$ , and therefore  $\text{Im } \omega < 0$  for a damped mode. In the neutral Schwarzschild limit  $q = Q = 0$ , Cavalcante and da Cunha report the spin-zero  $\ell = 2$  entry in Table I on page 6 from an isomonodromic Painlevé calculation and reproduce it in the adjacent column with a continued-fraction method [34]. After matching our  $e^{-i\omega t}$  convention, the value is

$$M\omega_{\text{ref}} = 0.483643872211 - 0.096758775978 i.$$

Throughout the numerical comparisons we use

$$\Delta_{\text{rel}}(\omega_1, \omega_2) = \frac{|\omega_1 - \omega_2|}{|\omega_2|}.$$

Here  $\omega_2$  is the reference value. At  $N = 96$ , the direct spectral calculation gives

$$M\omega_{\text{spec}} = 0.483643872189 - 0.096758775961 i,$$

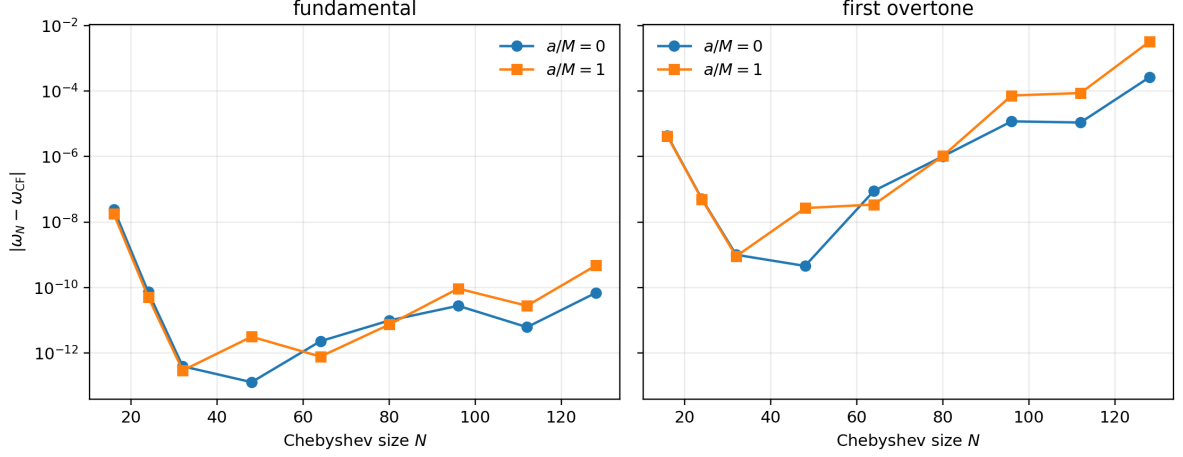
with relative difference  $5.60 \times 10^{-11}$  from that external value. This is substantially sharper than the baseline time-domain fit,  $0.483642480 - 0.096758919 i$ , and the waveform matrix-pencil diagnostic,  $0.483653530 - 0.096763421 i$ .

The Leaver-style solver gives

$$M\omega_{\text{Leaver}} = 0.483643872211 - 0.096758775978 i$$

for the Schwarzschild fundamental mode, with relative difference  $8.24 \times 10^{-13}$  from the same external value. Such accuracy is routine for mature Schwarzschild solvers [18, 34]; its role here is to verify the conventions, endpoint factors, and branch identification in both of our frequency-domain implementations.

Figure 1 shows how the Chebyshev roots approach an order-128, depth-320 continued-fraction value. The fundamental settles onto a double-precision plateau. The first overtone behaves differently: agreement is best near  $N = 32$ –48 and worsens as the differentiation matrices become more ill-conditioned at larger  $N$ , a familiar limitation of high-order collocation in finite precision [27]. We therefore describe these modes as cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ , rather than interpreting the largest available grid as automatically the most accurate.



**Figure 1** Chebyshev error relative to the order-128, depth-320 continued-fraction root for scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamentals (left) and first overtones (right), including  $N = 128$ . The overtone panel displays the high- $N$  deterioration directly.

As an upper-grid check, we also recomputed the scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  branch at  $N = 128$  for  $a/M = 0$  and 1. The shifts from  $N = 96$  are  $6.95 \times 10^{-11}$  and  $4.64 \times 10^{-10}$ , respectively, far below the scale of any deformation trend reported below. The small nonmonotonic motion between  $N = 96$  and 128 is consistent with roundoff amplification in the differentiation matrices and the linearized pencil [27]. We use  $N = 96$  for the fundamental catalogue and take the collocation-independent continued fraction as the external numerical anchor.

### 3.2 Leaver continued-fraction comparison

Table 1 summarizes the Leaver-style continued-fraction validation against the targeted Chebyshev spectral rows used for the scalar comparison.

| $a/M$ | mode           | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{Leaver}})$ | $\text{Im}(M\omega_{\text{Leaver}})$ | $\Delta_{\text{rel}}(\text{spec, Leaver})$ |
|-------|----------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 0.0   | fundamental    | 0.48364387                           | -0.09675878                          | $7.914 \times 10^{-13}$                    |
| 0.0   | first overtone | 0.46385058                           | -0.29560394                          | $1.814 \times 10^{-9}$                     |
| 0.2   | fundamental    | 0.48203369                           | -0.09665386                          | $6.084 \times 10^{-13}$                    |
| 0.2   | first overtone | 0.46216559                           | -0.29531130                          | $1.788 \times 10^{-9}$                     |
| 0.5   | fundamental    | 0.47388693                           | -0.09610918                          | $6.219 \times 10^{-13}$                    |
| 0.5   | first overtone | 0.45364275                           | -0.29379018                          | $1.808 \times 10^{-9}$                     |
| 1.0   | fundamental    | 0.44836241                           | -0.09424818                          | $6.341 \times 10^{-13}$                    |
| 1.0   | first overtone | 0.42697149                           | -0.28857291                          | $1.747 \times 10^{-9}$                     |

**Table 1** Leaver-style continued-fraction validation against targeted Chebyshev spectral results at  $N = 32$ . Frequency columns are rounded for display; the discrepancy column is computed from full-precision internal values. The Leaver solver avoids Chebyshev collocation, matrix-pencil data, and residual minimization, while sharing the same perturbation equation and endpoint factorization. The stricter scalar comparison shown here fails if the relative difference exceeds  $10^{-6}$ ; the looser general catalogue gate of  $10^{-4}$  exists only to accommodate the exploratory  $n = 2$  tier. The largest difference in this table is  $1.814 \times 10^{-9}$ .

Table 2 isolates continued-fraction truncation from the spectral comparison. The fundamental modes stabilize by depth 90 at the shown precision. The deformed first overtone is more sensitive, but its depth-240 and depth-320 values differ by only  $2.05 \times 10^{-12}$ . This is consistent with treating the scalar  $n = 1$  modes as cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$  while retaining a stronger precision assignment for the fundamentals.

| case                  | CF depth | $\text{Re}(M\omega)$ | $\text{Im}(M\omega)$ | $ \omega - \omega_{320} $ |
|-----------------------|----------|----------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| Schwarzschild $n = 0$ | 60       | 0.483643872211       | -0.096758775978      | $2.68 \times 10^{-13}$    |
|                       | 90       | 0.483643872211       | -0.096758775978      | $4.89 \times 10^{-16}$    |
|                       | 120      | 0.483643872211       | -0.096758775978      | 0                         |
|                       | 240      | 0.483643872211       | -0.096758775978      | 0                         |
|                       | 320      | 0.483643872211       | -0.096758775978      | 0                         |
| KS $a/M = 1, n = 0$   | 60       | 0.448362409002       | -0.094248179159      | $1.76 \times 10^{-13}$    |
|                       | 90       | 0.448362409002       | -0.094248179159      | $1.35 \times 10^{-15}$    |
|                       | 120      | 0.448362409002       | -0.094248179159      | $3.93 \times 10^{-16}$    |
|                       | 240      | 0.448362409002       | -0.094248179159      | $5.55 \times 10^{-17}$    |
|                       | 320      | 0.448362409002       | -0.094248179159      | 0                         |
| KS $a/M = 1, n = 1$   | 60       | 0.426971489725       | -0.288572913307      | $2.09 \times 10^{-10}$    |
|                       | 90       | 0.426971489574       | -0.288572913453      | $1.12 \times 10^{-12}$    |
|                       | 120      | 0.426971489576       | -0.288572913449      | $2.84 \times 10^{-12}$    |
|                       | 240      | 0.426971489574       | -0.288572913453      | $2.05 \times 10^{-12}$    |
|                       | 320      | 0.426971489574       | -0.288572913452      | 0                         |

**Table 2** Continued-fraction depth check at fixed Taylor order 96. Each solve uses the branch-tracked  $N = 32$  Chebyshev value only as an initial guess; the last column compares with the depth-320 root. The table is generated by `scripts/analyze_leaver_convergence.py`.

Taylor-order convergence was tested separately at fixed continued-fraction depth 320. Table 3 reports the complex-frequency difference from order 128. At the production order 96 the largest difference among these cases is  $4.32 \times 10^{-12}$ .

| case                              | 64                     | 80                     | 96                     | 112                    | 128 |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|-----|
| scalar $\ell = 2, n = 0, a/M = 1$ | $2.90 \times 10^{-13}$ | $1.60 \times 10^{-14}$ | $2.50 \times 10^{-15}$ | 0                      | 0   |
| scalar $\ell = 2, n = 1, a/M = 1$ | $1.20 \times 10^{-9}$  | $4.32 \times 10^{-12}$ | $4.32 \times 10^{-12}$ | $3.30 \times 10^{-13}$ | 0   |
| axial $\ell = 2, n = 0, a/M = 1$  | $3.09 \times 10^{-12}$ | $1.67 \times 10^{-13}$ | $6.13 \times 10^{-14}$ | $3.40 \times 10^{-15}$ | 0   |

**Table 3** Absolute difference  $|\omega_p - \omega_{128}|$  under one-at-a-time variation of the Frobenius Taylor order  $p$ , with continued-fraction depth 320 fixed. Generated by `scripts/analyze_solver_convergence.py`.

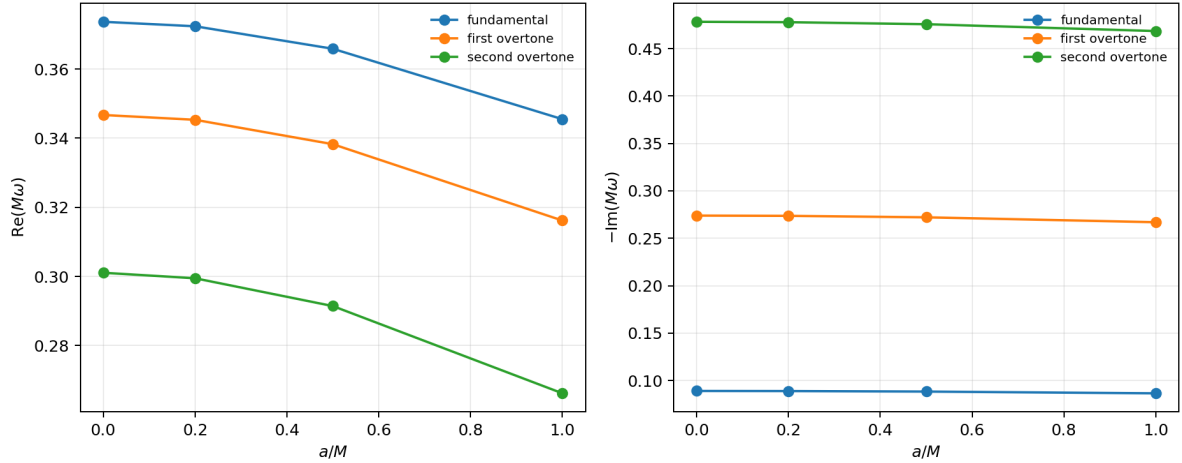
### 3.3 Gauge-invariant odd-parity gravitational sector

We next apply the same Chebyshev and continued-fraction calculations to the gauge-invariant inverse-Cowling axial equation for  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$  and low-lying indices  $n = 0, 1, 2$ . Together with the scalar rows, the working catalogue contains 72 entries over  $a/M = 0, 0.2, 0.5, 1.0$ . The axial entries are conditional inverse-Cowling modes of the explicitly stated closure. At  $a = 0$ , the effective source vanishes and the model reduces exactly to the Schwarzschild Regge–Wheeler equation [1, 2, 4]. Table 4 lists the resulting continued-fraction frequencies. External high-precision comparisons are reported separately below.

| $\ell$ | $n$ | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{Leaver}})$ | $\text{Im}(M\omega_{\text{Leaver}})$ |
|--------|-----|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 2      | 0   | 0.37367168                           | -0.08896232                          |
| 2      | 1   | 0.34671100                           | -0.27391488                          |
| 2      | 2   | 0.30105346                           | -0.47827698                          |
| 3      | 0   | 0.59944329                           | -0.09270305                          |
| 3      | 1   | 0.58264380                           | -0.28129811                          |
| 3      | 2   | 0.55168490                           | -0.47909275                          |
| 4      | 0   | 0.80917838                           | -0.09416396                          |
| 4      | 1   | 0.79663153                           | -0.28433435                          |
| 4      | 2   | 0.77270953                           | -0.47990818                          |

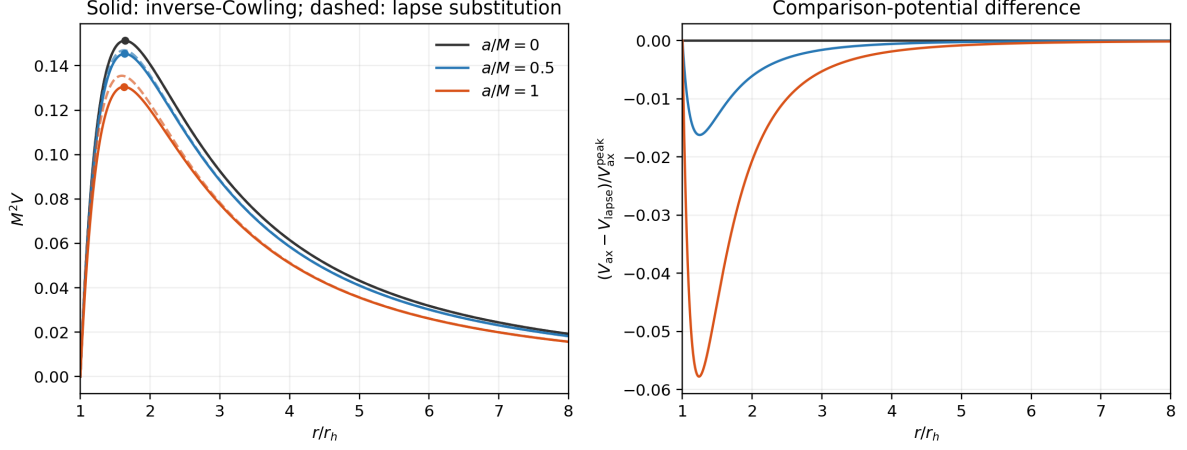
**Table 4** Schwarzschild Regge–Wheeler frequencies obtained by the continued-fraction solver. At  $a = 0$ , the effective-source model reduces exactly to the Schwarzschild Regge–Wheeler equation. Because available tabulations have uneven numbers of significant figures, their rounded entries are used only as branch-identification targets; the quantitative accuracy check against a named high-precision calculation is reported separately below.

Representative gauge-invariant inverse-Cowling axial  $\ell = 2$  trajectories over the deformation grid are shown in Figure 2.



**Figure 2** Representative  $\ell = 2$  conditional odd-parity mode trajectories of the gauge-invariant inverse-Cowling effective-source model versus  $a/M$ . They are not predictions of an unspecified quantum nonspherical completion.

Figure 3 compares the inverse-Cowling potential with the lapse-substitution potential in Eq. (17). At  $a/M = 1$ , the maximum absolute correction is 5.77% of the new barrier height; over the region where the new potential exceeds  $10^{-3}$  of its peak, the maximum pointwise fractional correction is 15.1%. These definitions avoid a spurious relative divergence at the horizon and infinity, where both potentials vanish.



**Figure 3** Left: inverse-Cowling axial potential (solid) and the explicitly defined lapse-substitution comparison potential (dashed) for  $\ell = 2$ ; circles mark the inverse-Cowling potential peaks and the vertical line marks  $r = r_h$ . Right: their difference normalized by the new barrier height.

The same potential and mass normalization are used by the public 2026 high-precision Chebyshev calculation of Batic, Dutykh, and Sukaiti [6]. We compared all 18 overlapping  $a/M = 0.5, 1$ ,  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$ ,  $n = 0, 1, 2$  entries. The largest relative difference is  $1.98 \times 10^{-13}$  for fundamentals,  $3.80 \times 10^{-10}$  for first overtones, and  $1.62 \times 10^{-5}$  for second overtones. The last occurs at  $a/M = 1$ ,  $\ell = 2$ ,  $n = 2$  and reinforces the exploratory status of that tier. The comparison, parameter conversion check, public repository commit, and local source commit are recorded by `scripts/audit_axial_model.py`.

As a stability diagnostic, the potential was minimized numerically outside the horizon for every sampled  $a/M$  and  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$ . It remained non-negative and approached zero only at the two boundaries. The finite-spectrum search was applied before the ordinary damped-mode window: all finite roots satisfying  $\text{Im } \omega > 10^{-8}$  and  $|\omega| < 5$  were retained at  $N = 32, 48, 64$ , and persistence required agreement within  $10^{-4}$  at all three sizes. Any persistent candidate was to be locally residual-refined within radius 0.02 at  $N = 64$  and accepted only if its polynomial backward error was below  $10^{-8}$ . No raw positive-imaginary root occurred, so the refinement stage was not invoked and no growing candidate survived. Positivity supplies the usual sufficient mode-stability argument for this source-free one-dimensional problem. For a hypothetical mode with  $\text{Im } \omega > 0$ , the QNM boundary conditions make the radial solution decay at both asymptotic ends; multiplying the source-free master equation by  $\Psi_{ax}^*$ , integrating, and using the standard positive-energy identity excludes a growing mode when  $V_{ax} \geq 0$  [5]. This statement applies only to the inverse-Cowling model and does not establish stability under other effective-source closures; the finite root search is an additional numerical check.

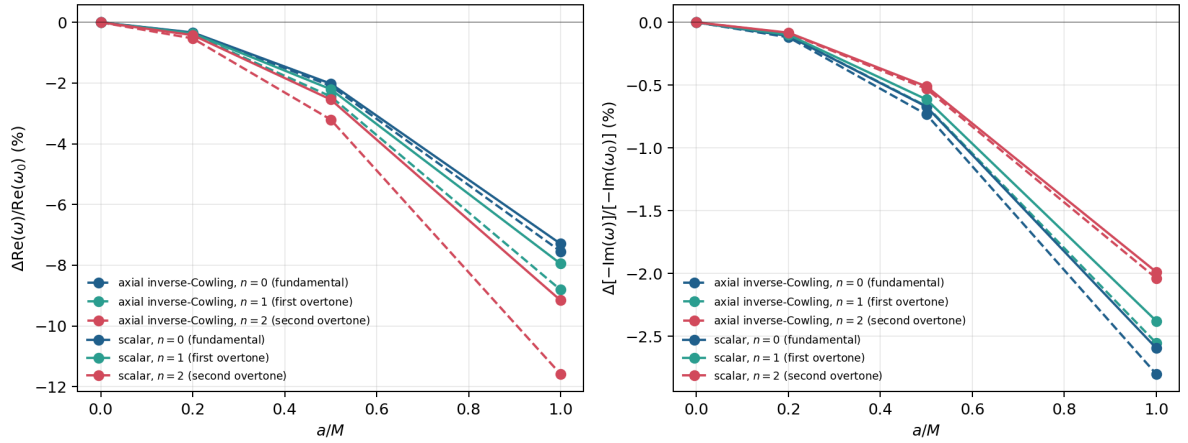
Across the low-lying catalogue, the largest spectral-continued-fraction difference is  $1.202 \times 10^{-5}$ , for the axial  $\ell = 2$ ,  $n = 2$  branch at  $a/M = 0.5$ . The axial fundamentals are much more stable numerically. We keep the  $n = 1$  and  $n = 2$  axial values because they show how the branches move, but all axial modes inherit the inverse-Cowling assumption and the  $n = 2$  entries carry the additional overtone uncertainty familiar from KS studies [17].

### 3.4 Catalogue-level deformation trends

To isolate the effect of the KS deformation, we compare each branch with its own Schwarzschild value at fixed  $M$ . Both the real frequency and the damping magnitude decrease monotonically on the sampled grid for every scalar branch. The inverse-Cowling axial branches follow the same trend, although their physical interpretation remains conditional on the frozen-source assumption.

At the upper endpoint of the sampled interval,  $a/M = 1$ , the scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamental shifts are  $-7.29\%$  in  $\text{Re}(M\omega)$ ,  $-2.59\%$  in the damping magnitude  $-\text{Im}(M\omega)$ , and  $7.17\%$  in the complex-plane displacement  $|\Delta\omega|/|\omega(a=0)|$ . These are distinct quantities and are not referred to interchangeably below. Among the scalar fundamentals, the  $\ell = 4$  branch has the largest complex-plane displacement,  $7.23\%$ , while its real-part shift is  $-7.27\%$ . The scalar  $\ell = 2$  second overtone has a larger real-part shift,  $-9.16\%$ , but is an exploratory branch diagnostic. The  $\ell = 2$  trends are plotted in Figure 4.

Within the closure-dependent axial fundamentals, the largest complex-plane displacement is  $7.37\%$  for  $\ell = 2$ , with shifts of  $-7.54\%$  in the real part and  $-2.80\%$  in damping magnitude. This value is reported separately because it depends on the frozen-source assumption, whereas the scalar comparison above does not.



**Figure 4** Schwarzschild-relative trends over the sampled interval for the  $\ell = 2$  branches. Solid curves show scalar modes and dashed curves show the gauge-invariant inverse-Cowling axial modes. The latter are conditional on the closure stated in Section 2.1.

The mild increase of the scalar fundamental displacement from  $\ell = 2$  to  $\ell = 4$  is already visible in the effective-potential barrier. Table 5 reports the peak analysis at  $a/M = 1$ . The leading WKB proxy  $\text{Re } \omega \sim \sqrt{V_{\text{peak}}}$  changes by  $-7.01\%$ ,  $-7.13\%$ , and  $-7.18\%$  for  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$ , respectively, mirroring the modest multipole dependence of the computed fundamentals. The curvature change also grows slightly with  $\ell$ , consistent with a weak multipole-dependence in the damping. This is precisely the level of intuition expected from leading WKB theory [22, 23]; the data do not suggest a separate  $\ell = 4$  mechanism.



| $\ell$ | $r_{\text{peak}}/M$ | $\Delta V_{\text{peak}}$ | $\Delta\sqrt{V_{\text{peak}}}$ | $\Delta V''_{*,\text{peak}} $ |
|--------|---------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 2      | 3.25198574          | -13.5350%                | -7.0134%                       | -17.7698%                     |
| 3      | 3.28015848          | -13.7535%                | -7.1310%                       | -18.1334%                     |
| 4      | 3.29264164          | -13.8440%                | -7.1797%                       | -18.2801%                     |

**Table 5** Scalar effective-potential peak changes at  $a/M = 1$ , relative to the Schwarzschild peak at the same  $\ell$ . Primes denote tortoise-coordinate derivatives. These diagnostics are generated by `scripts/analyze_scalar_potential_peaks.py` and provide only WKB intuition; the QNM frequencies come from the Chebyshev and continued-fraction calculations.

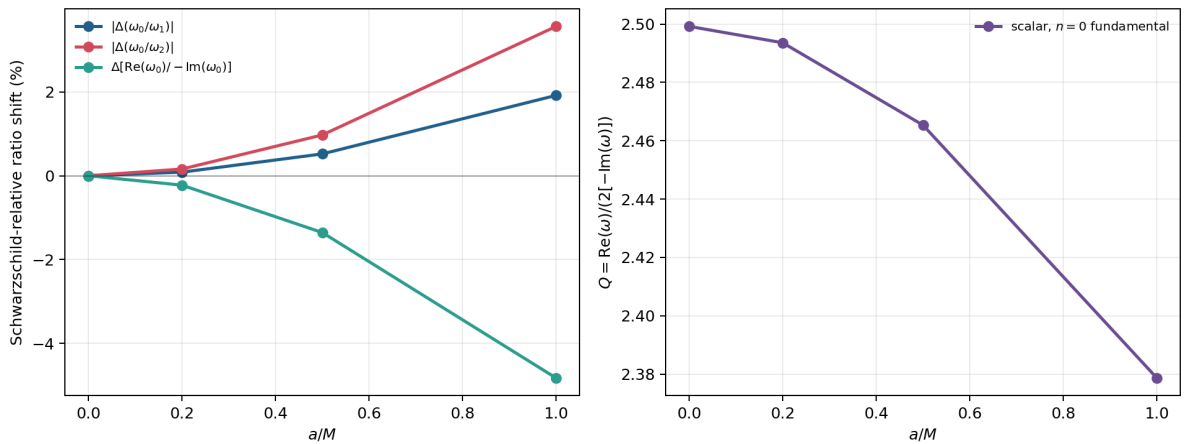
### 3.5 Spectroscopy diagnostics

At fixed mass, the shift has a straightforward spectroscopic meaning. The decrease in  $\text{Re}(M\omega)$  lowers the oscillation frequency, while the decrease in  $-\text{Im}(M\omega)$  lengthens the damping time. Following the standard ringdown convention [9, 12], we define

$$Q = \frac{\text{Re } \omega}{2[-\text{Im } \omega]}.$$

For the scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamental branch, the damping magnitude decreases by 2.59%, corresponding to an approximate 2.7% increase in damping time. Because the oscillation frequency decreases by a larger fraction,  $Q$  decreases by 4.83%: the scalar perturbation decays slightly more slowly, but it completes fewer oscillations per damping time.

Dimensionless mode ratios are useful because a common rescaling of the black-hole mass cannot absorb them, which is why they play a central role in ringdown spectroscopy [12, 13]. For the scalar  $\ell = 2$  branch at  $a/M = 1$ , the complex ratio  $\omega_0/\omega_1$  changes from  $0.836060 + 0.324207i$  to  $0.823241 + 0.335659i$ , a 1.92% displacement in the complex-ratio plane. The corresponding  $\omega_0/\omega_2$  ratio moves by 3.56%. The branch-wise quantity  $\text{Re}(\omega)/[-\text{Im}(\omega)] = 2Q$  changes by -4.83%, -5.71%, and -7.31% for  $n = 0, 1, 2$ , respectively. The  $n = 2$  number is included only as an exploratory diagnostic. Figure 5 collects these ratios and the fundamental  $Q(a/M)$  curve.



**Figure 5** Scalar  $\ell = 2$  dimensionless spectroscopy diagnostics. The left panel shows Schwarzschild-relative changes in  $\omega_0/\omega_1$ ,  $\omega_0/\omega_2$ , and  $2Q$ . The right panel directly plots  $Q = \text{Re } \omega/[2(-\text{Im } \omega)]$  for the robust fundamental branch. These quantities are catalogue diagnostics rather than an observational forecast.

The scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamental is consequently the best-controlled spectroscopic quantity in this calculation. It is a quadrupolar test-field mode, not the gravitational  $\ell = m = 2$  ringdown mode measured by an interferometer. Connecting the percent-level shifts found here to data would require a gravitational waveform, detector-noise weighting, and a simultaneous treatment of mass, spin, and mode amplitudes [12, 13]. Our result is more modest but still physical: at fixed mass, the KS deformation softens the low-lying scalar spectrum throughout the sampled interval.

### 3.6 Comparison with existing KS literature

Our results fit naturally into the existing KS literature. Konoplya studied scalar, electromagnetic, and Dirac perturbations with WKB and time-domain methods, together with scattering and shadow observables [16]. Bolokhov, Bronnikov, and Konoplya later used a Frobenius continued fraction to show that KS overtones can respond much more strongly than the fundamental mode [17]. The present calculation confirms the comparatively smooth fundamental branches and quantifies them with a fixed-mass spectral comparison.

Direct row-by-row numerical comparison requires care because the tabulated conventions and parameter normalizations differ. In particular, much of the earlier KS QNM literature fixes the horizon radius, while the catalogue here is organized at fixed mass scale and reports  $a/M$ . For the lapse in Eq. (1), a horizon-normalized parameter  $\beta = a/r_h$  corresponds to  $\alpha = a/M = 2\beta/\sqrt{1-\beta^2}$ , while  $r_h\omega = \sqrt{4+\alpha^2}M\omega$ . Thus the  $a/M = 1$  endpoint in this paper corresponds to  $a/r_h = 1/\sqrt{5}$ , not to a horizon-normalized  $a/r_h = 1$  table row.

A direct numerical overlap is available for the scalar  $\ell = 0, n = 0$  fundamental tabulated by Konoplya at fixed  $r_h = 1$  [16]. After converting  $\beta = a/r_h$  to  $\alpha = a/M$ , our horizon-scaled frequencies agree with the published time-domain values at the  $2.1 \times 10^{-3}$ – $2.6 \times 10^{-3}$  level. Agreement with the seventh-order WKB values is weaker,  $9.4 \times 10^{-3}$ – $1.2 \times 10^{-2}$ , as expected for a low- $\ell$  mode [23, 10]. This comparison also makes clear why the normalization must be matched before two KS tables are compared.

| $\beta = a/r_h$ | $\alpha = a/M$ | this work $r_h\omega$ | Konoplya time-domain $r_h\omega$ | $\Delta_{\text{rel}}$  |
|-----------------|----------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------|
| 0.10            | 0.201008       | 0.221242 – 0.210676 i | 0.221470 – 0.211440 i            | $2.603 \times 10^{-3}$ |
| 0.20            | 0.408248       | 0.222244 – 0.213397 i | 0.222370 – 0.214200 i            | $2.631 \times 10^{-3}$ |
| 0.50            | 1.154701       | 0.229462 – 0.235795 i | 0.230120 – 0.236200 i            | $2.343 \times 10^{-3}$ |

**Table 6** Normalization-matched comparison with the scalar  $\ell = 0, n = 0$  fixed-horizon table of Konoplya [16]. The main catalogue starts at  $\ell = 2$ ; these rows test the parameter conversion and reproduce the published scalar fundamental once the  $r_h\omega$  convention is matched.

The overtone comparison with Bolokhov–Bronnikov–Konoplya is qualitative because their published figures concern scalar  $\ell = 0$  branches with  $n = 5, 7, 9$ , whereas our catalogue covers  $\ell = 2, 3, 4$  only through  $n = 2$  [17]. Both calculations nevertheless show the same hierarchy: fundamentals vary smoothly, while overtones are more deformation-sensitive and more demanding numerically. Our additional results are the fixed-mass branch comparison, the quality-factor and mode-ratio shifts, and the singular-value diagnostics.

### 3.7 Reported scalar rows

Table 7 collects the scalar rows used in the numerical comparison and separates the time-domain orientation from the frequency-domain values discussed in the text.

| $a/M$ | $N$ | mode           | status          | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{fit}})$ | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{pencil}})$ | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{spec}})$ | $\text{Im}(M\omega_{\text{spec}})$ |
|-------|-----|----------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 0.0   | 96  | fundamental    | high- $N$       | 0.48364248                        | 0.48365353                           | 0.48364387                         | -0.09675878                        |
| 0.0   | 32  | first overtone | cross-validated | –                                 | –                                    | 0.46385058                         | -0.29560394                        |
| 0.2   | 96  | fundamental    | high- $N$       | 0.48203239                        | 0.48204305                           | 0.48203369                         | -0.09665386                        |
| 0.2   | 32  | first overtone | cross-validated | –                                 | –                                    | 0.46216559                         | -0.29531130                        |
| 0.5   | 96  | fundamental    | high- $N$       | 0.47388656                        | 0.47389459                           | 0.47388693                         | -0.09610918                        |
| 0.5   | 32  | first overtone | cross-validated | –                                 | –                                    | 0.45364275                         | -0.29379018                        |
| 1.0   | 96  | fundamental    | high- $N$       | 0.44836165                        | 0.44836213                           | 0.44836241                         | -0.09424818                        |
| 1.0   | 32  | first overtone | cross-validated | –                                 | –                                    | 0.42697149                         | -0.28857291                        |

**Table 7** Scalar frequency comparison. Fundamental branches are reported at  $N = 96$ ; the cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$  are quoted on that grid. Displayed decimals identify the branches; the supported precision is determined from spectral convergence and the continued fraction, not from the residual alone. High- $N$  overtone tracking is retained only as an exploratory diagnostic.

### 3.8 Residual diagnostics

Table 8 reports scale-aware residual diagnostics associated with the same scalar rows. The polynomial backward error is

$$\eta_{\text{back}}(\omega) = \frac{\sigma_{\min}[P_N(\omega)]}{\|A_0\|_2 + |\omega|\|A_1\|_2 + |\omega|^2\|A_2\|_2}. \quad (25)$$

| $a/M$ | $N$ | mode           | dim | $\sigma_{\min}(P_N)$    | $\eta_{\text{back}}$    |
|-------|-----|----------------|-----|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| 0.0   | 96  | fundamental    | 96  | $1.036 \times 10^{-19}$ | $4.542 \times 10^{-22}$ |
| 0.0   | 32  | first overtone | 32  | $4.271 \times 10^{-19}$ | $1.713 \times 10^{-20}$ |
| 0.2   | 96  | fundamental    | 96  | $8.244 \times 10^{-21}$ | $3.625 \times 10^{-23}$ |
| 0.2   | 32  | first overtone | 32  | $3.123 \times 10^{-19}$ | $1.256 \times 10^{-20}$ |
| 0.5   | 96  | fundamental    | 96  | $5.098 \times 10^{-20}$ | $2.272 \times 10^{-22}$ |
| 0.5   | 32  | first overtone | 32  | $3.598 \times 10^{-19}$ | $1.468 \times 10^{-20}$ |
| 1.0   | 96  | fundamental    | 96  | $4.017 \times 10^{-20}$ | $1.873 \times 10^{-22}$ |
| 1.0   | 32  | first overtone | 32  | $1.096 \times 10^{-19}$ | $4.696 \times 10^{-21}$ |

**Table 8** Residual diagnostics for the reported spectral branches. Both quantities are evaluated by SVD on the raw, unscaled polynomial matrices; the row/column equilibration used to generate eigenvalue candidates is not used here. Backward error is scale aware but is still interpreted together with spectral-size and continued-fraction convergence.

Hermiticity and positive semidefiniteness of  $R_N = P_N^\dagger P_N$  are algebraic properties, up to floating-point roundoff; they are not presented as empirical validation. The automated tests instead check their numerical implementation, Schwarzschild recovery, scaling invariance of the selected root, the inverse-Cowling axial potential, and the numerically distinct validation paths.

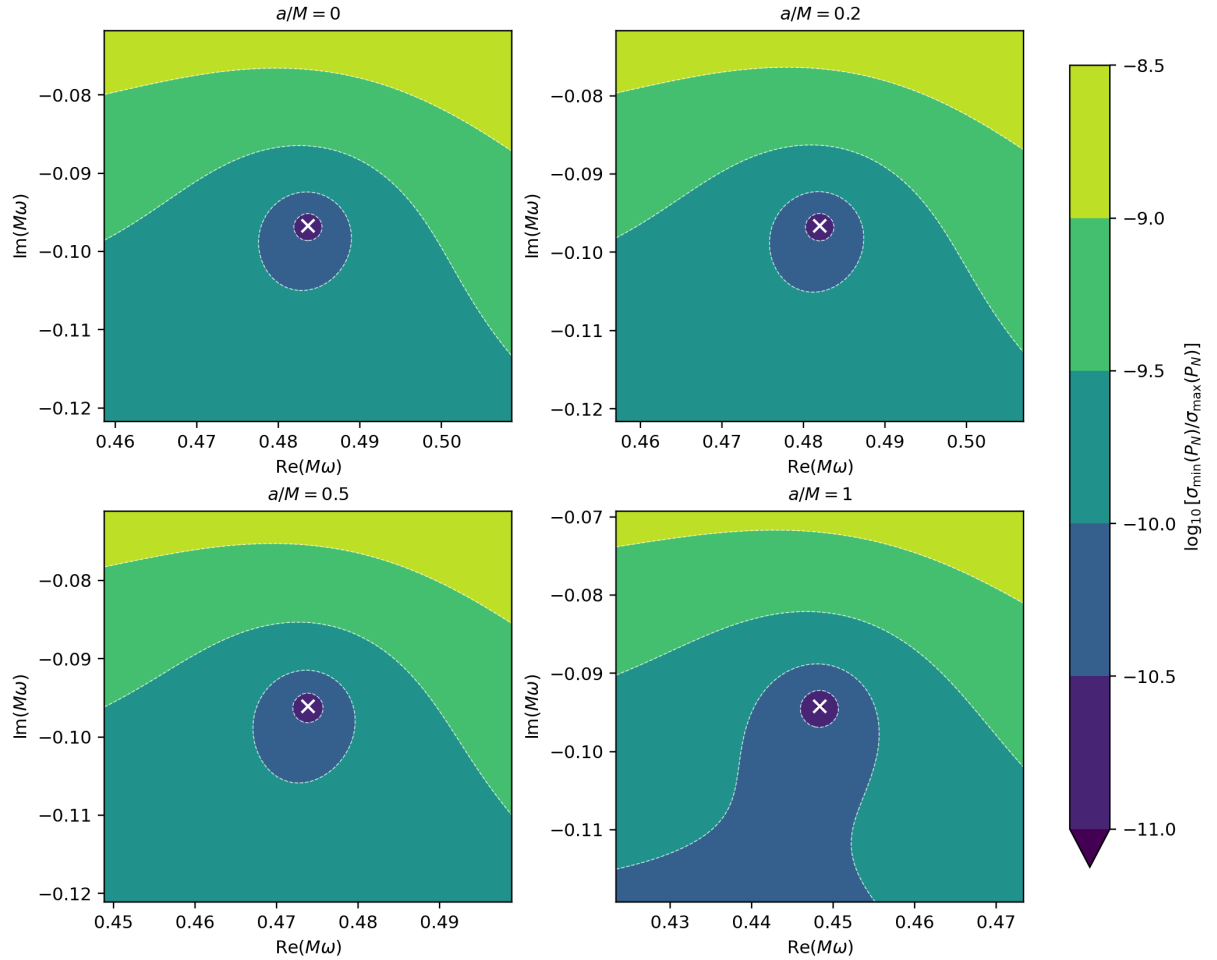
### 3.9 Local singular-value pseudospectral diagnostics of the scalar fundamental mode

The same residual operator gives a local finite-dimensional singular-value pseudospectral diagnostic around a validated branch. Following the singular-value viewpoint used in black-hole pseudospectrum studies [31, 32], define

$$\eta_N(\omega) = \frac{\sigma_{\min}(P_N(\omega))}{\sigma_{\max}(P_N(\omega))}. \quad (26)$$

This relative residual is used here only as a Chebyshev-matrix diagnostic for the scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  branch.

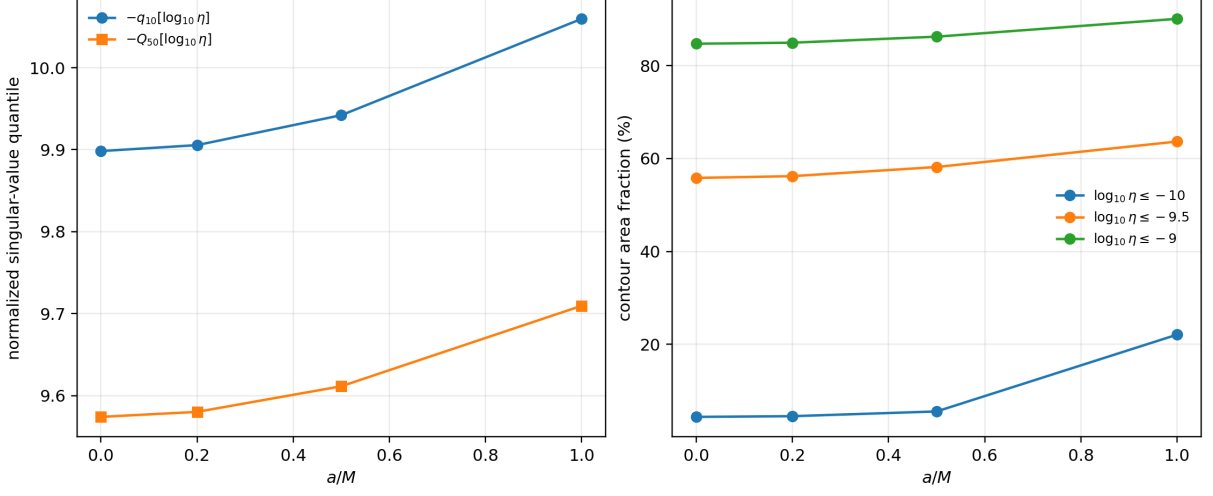
Figure 6 shows contours of  $\log_{10} \eta_N$  around the residual-minimized scalar fundamental frequencies for  $a/M = 0, 0.2, 0.5, 1.0$ , using  $N = 64$ , an  $81 \times 81$  grid, and a square half-width 0.025 in the complex  $M\omega$  plane. The contour centers agree with the Leaver frequencies to at worst  $6.816 \times 10^{-12}$  in relative difference, so the plotted basins are attached to the validated scalar branch.



**Figure 6** Finite-dimensional scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  singular-value pseudospectral contours for the relative residual  $\eta_N = \sigma_{\min}(P_N)/\sigma_{\max}(P_N)$  at  $N = 64$ . White crosses mark the residual-minimized QNM locations. The panels show that the local small- $\eta_N$  basin broadens as  $a/M$  increases.

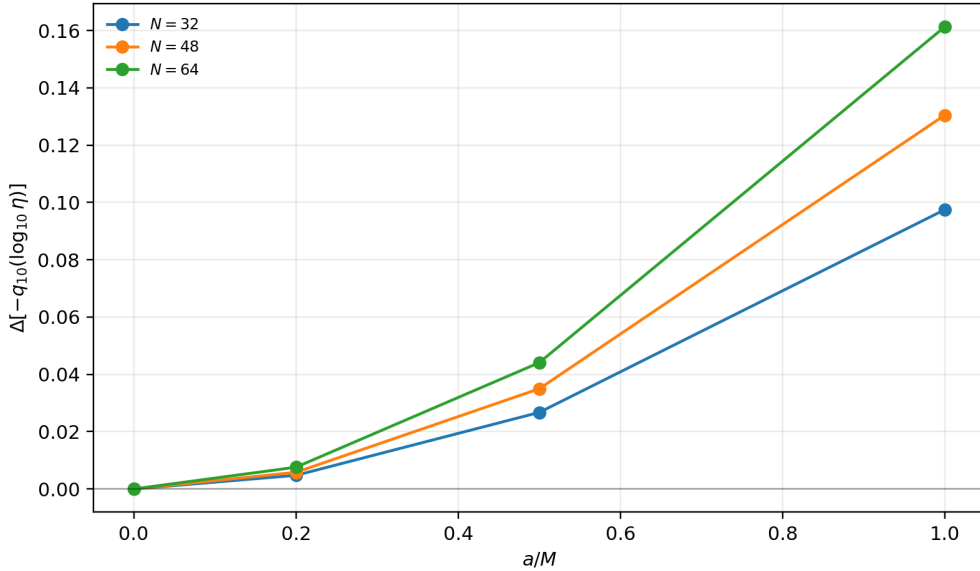
Quantile and area diagnostics give the same trend. Let  $q_p$  denote the  $p$ -quantile of  $\log_{10} \eta_N$  over the local window; lower-case  $q_p$  distinguishes this statistic from the QNM quality factor  $Q$ . At  $N = 64$ ,  $-q_{10}$  rises from 9.898 at  $a/M = 0$  to 10.060 at  $a/M = 1$ , while  $-q_{50}$  rises from

9.574 to 9.710. The area fraction satisfying  $\log_{10} \eta_N \leq -10$  grows from 4.36% to 22.07%, a factor of 5.06. The upper-interval contour is window-limited, so the area is used only as a local diagnostic. These diagnostics are plotted in Figure 7.



**Figure 7** Scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  singular-value pseudospectral diagnostics at  $N = 64$ . Left: the normalized singular-value quantiles change with  $a/M$ . Right: fixed-threshold contour area fractions also grow; the deepest endpoint contour is window-limited and is used only as a local diagnostic.

The sign of the quantile trend is stable under the tested spectral sizes. As shown in Figure 8, the  $a/M = 0$  to  $a/M = 1$  gain in  $-q_{10}$  is 0.097, 0.130, and 0.161 for  $N = 32, 48, 64$ , respectively. Thus, within the present residual normalization, scalar fundamental softening is associated with increasing local pseudospectral sensitivity.



**Figure 8** Finite- $N$  check for the scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  singular-value pseudospectral trend. The plotted quantity is the increase in  $-q_{10}(\log_{10} \eta_N)$  relative to the Schwarzschild value at the same  $N$ . The successive increase across the sampled  $a/M$  grid is stable for  $N = 32, 48, 64$ , although the absolute contour levels remain resolution dependent.

The dependence on grid density, frequency window, and spectral size is summarized in Table 9. It varies one numerical control at a time around the  $N = 64$ ,  $121^2$ -grid, half-width-0.025 reference. The endpoint change remains positive in all seven configurations and spans 0.1002–0.1647. The sign and order of magnitude are therefore robust, whereas the third decimal of a single-window result has no physical significance.

| test          | $N$ | grid    | half-width | $\Delta[-q_{10}(\log_{10} \eta_N)]$ |
|---------------|-----|---------|------------|-------------------------------------|
| grid          | 64  | $81^2$  | 0.025      | 0.1613                              |
| grid          | 64  | $121^2$ | 0.025      | 0.1603                              |
| grid          | 64  | $161^2$ | 0.025      | 0.1607                              |
| window        | 64  | $121^2$ | 0.020      | 0.1396                              |
| window        | 64  | $121^2$ | 0.030      | 0.1647                              |
| spectral size | 32  | $121^2$ | 0.025      | 0.1002                              |
| spectral size | 48  | $121^2$ | 0.025      | 0.1287                              |

**Table 9** Robustness of the scalar-fundamental endpoint change in  $-q_{10}(\log_{10} \eta_N)$  between  $a/M = 0$  and  $a/M = 1$ . Every configuration gives the same positive sign and comparable magnitude. Full-precision values are generated by `scripts/audit_pseudospectrum_robustness.py`.

## 4 Discussion

The clearest physical result is the systematic softening of the scalar spectrum. As  $a/M$  increases, the potential barrier moves and decreases, and both the oscillation frequency and the magnitude of the damping rate fall. For the scalar  $\ell = 2$  fundamental at  $a/M = 1$ , the changes are  $-7.29\%$  in  $\text{Re } \omega$ ,  $-2.59\%$  in  $-\text{Im } \omega$ , and  $-4.83\%$  in  $Q$ . The weak  $\ell$ -dependence follows the height and curvature of the scalar barrier in the manner expected from WKB theory [22, 23]. These results extend the qualitative softening found in earlier KS calculations to a fixed-mass, low-lying spectral catalogue [16, 17].

The agreement between Chebyshev and Frobenius calculations is strongest for the fundamentals and remains excellent for the first overtones at  $N = 32$ . The second overtones are less regular, with a maximum discrepancy of  $1.202 \times 10^{-5}$  on the axial  $\ell = 2$  branch. This behavior is not surprising: highly damped modes are well known to require greater care in both continued-fraction and spectral calculations [18, 19, 17, 35]. For this reason the scalar fundamentals are the quantitative core of the paper, the scalar  $n = 1$  modes are cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ , and the  $n = 2$  values are best regarded as indications of branch motion.

The local singular-value contours broaden with  $a/M$  on the scalar  $\ell = 2$ ,  $n = 0$  branch. Similar pseudospectral broadening has been used to expose the sensitivity of non-self-adjoint black-hole spectra [31, 32]. Our calculation is finite dimensional and local in the complex-frequency plane, so it does not establish a continuum instability. It does show, however, that the deformation changes not only the location of the resonance but also the local conditioning of the discretized spectral problem.

### 4.1 Limitations and reproducibility

#### 4.1.1 Interpretive boundaries

The scalar calculation requires only the KS metric and the minimally coupled Klein–Gordon equation, and is therefore the least model-dependent part of the analysis [14, 16]. The axial

master variable is gauge invariant, but its homogeneous equation is obtained only after setting the invariant odd effective-source amplitudes to zero [2, 3, 4]. The axial frequencies thus belong to this inverse-Cowling model. Gauge invariance does not make the closure unique.

Nor should the percent-level shifts be read directly as detector forecasts. Part of a dimensional frequency change is degenerate with the remnant mass, and a measurement requires mode amplitudes, a waveform model, detector noise, and covariances with mass and spin [12, 9, 13]. The dimensionless ratios reported above reduce the mass degeneracy but do not replace such an analysis.

The pseudospectral plots are built from finite Chebyshev matrices rather than a controlled infinite-dimensional KS operator. Normalizing by  $\sigma_{\max}$  removes an overall matrix scale, but not the dependence on discretization and norm. The robust statement is consequently limited to the observed branch: for  $N = 32, 48, 64$ , the endpoint quantile change has the same sign and comparable size. A continuum pseudospectrum would require a separate operator-theoretic treatment [31, 32].

Finally, the loss of monotonic Chebyshev convergence for the overtones prevents us from extending the same precision statement to arbitrary  $n$ . The reported  $n = 1$  frequencies are cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ ; the  $n = 2$  rows are included to show the emerging deformation trend, and higher overtones are not considered. Table 10 summarizes these distinctions.

| Branch            | Numerical status                                      | Physical interpretation                                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scalar $n = 0$    | Robust fundamental modes                              | Quantitative softening and spectroscopy results.                            |
| Scalar $n = 1$    | Cross-validated low-lying first overtones at $N = 32$ | Secondary diagnostics; high- $N$ tracking remains exploratory.              |
| Overtones $n = 2$ | Exploratory branch diagnostics                        | Qualitative deformation trends.                                             |
| Axial rows        | Conditional inverse-Cowling odd-parity modes          | Gauge-invariant metric variable with frozen axial effective-source current. |

**Table 10** Numerical and physical status of the reported branches. Scalar fundamentals and first overtones are distinguished from exploratory second overtones and closure-dependent axial modes.

#### 4.1.2 Reproducibility

The implementation is reproducible from the accompanying repository:

<https://github.com/adoolelomani2026/ks-qnm-spectral-residual-workflow>

The repository contains the Chebyshev spectral solver, the Leaver-style validation layer, catalogue-generation scripts, pseudospectrum diagnostics, generated tables, manuscript-supporting figures, and automated tests. The submission-facing commands are copied literally below.

```

pytest
python tests/test_qnm_algorithm.py --full
python scripts/run_hybrid_qnm_algorithm.py
python scripts/analyze_leaver_convergence.py
python scripts/analyze_solver_convergence.py
python scripts/analyze_scalar_potential_peaks.py

```



```
python scripts/audit_axial_model.py 531
python scripts/check_n128_spot.py 532
python scripts/analyze_pseudospectrum.py 533
python scripts/audit_pseudospectrum_robustness.py 534
python scripts/compare_konoplya2020_scalar_l0.py 535
```

The first two commands run the fast and complete scalar/axial validation suites. The remaining commands regenerate the main results, convergence audits, potential diagnostics, pseudospectrum data, and literature comparisons. These commands write the CSV tables, Markdown summaries, and figures under `outputs/results/` and `outputs/figures/`. The package versions used for the regenerated outputs are recorded in `outputs/results/run_metadata.json`.

## 5 Conclusion 541

We have computed the low-lying QNMs of the KS geometry at fixed mass using two numerically distinct frequency-domain methods. The scalar fundamentals soften steadily as  $a/M$  is increased. For  $\ell = 2$  at  $a/M = 1$ , the oscillation frequency, damping magnitude, and quality factor change by  $-7.29\%$ ,  $-2.59\%$ , and  $-4.83\%$ , respectively. The dimensionless  $\omega_0/\omega_1$  ratio moves by  $1.92\%$ . Together with the potential-peak analysis, these numbers show that the KS deformation produces a genuine percent-level shift of the test-scalar spectrum, not merely a change of units. This complements earlier WKB, time-domain, and Frobenius studies of the same geometry [16, 17].

At  $N = 32$ , the scalar fundamentals agree with the continued-fraction values to  $7.92 \times 10^{-13}$  or better on the sampled deformation grid. The  $N = 96$  values used for the principal scalar convergence study lie on the high-resolution plateau and differ from the continued-fraction values by  $1.23 \times 10^{-11}$ – $2.02 \times 10^{-10}$ . The first overtones exhibit a finite-precision optimum near  $N = 32$  and are therefore quoted as cross-validated low-lying first overtones at  $N = 32$ . The second overtones show larger truncation and branch sensitivity and remain exploratory. This is also why we make no claim about the highly damped spectrum, for which dedicated analytic-continuation methods are better suited [35].

For odd-parity gravitational perturbations, the gauge-invariant master variable obeys a sourced equation on a general spherical background [2, 3, 4]. Setting the invariant axial effective-source current to zero gives the inverse-Cowling potential used here, which differs from a simple lapse-deformed Regge–Wheeler potential. Its frequencies provide a useful numerical comparison and agree closely with an separate Chebyshev calculation [6], but their physical meaning remains conditional on the frozen-source closure. A complete nonspherical quantum theory of the KS source would be needed to remove that assumption.

Finally, the singular-value calculation shows that the local finite- $N$  pseudospectral basin of the scalar fundamental broadens with deformation. The trend survives changes in grid size and frequency window, although it should not be confused with a continuum pseudospectrum. More broadly, the combination of Chebyshev roots, residual minima, branch continuation, backward error, and a Frobenius calculation provides a transparent way to separate well-resolved KS resonances from numerically fragile overtones [18, 27, 31].

## A Schwarzschild branch-identification seeds

Table 11 records every initial target used at  $a/M = 0$ . Each is a literature value: no seed was selected manually and no continued-fraction result was used as an initial Schwarzschild seed. For each  $(s, \ell, n)$ , the code chooses the nearest distinct  $N = 32$  Chebyshev candidate and refines it with the continued fraction. The accepted continued-fraction root then becomes the target at the next value of  $a/M$ . The machine-readable table, including a provenance field for every row, is generated as `outputs/results/schwarzschild_branch_seeds.csv`.

| sector | $\ell$ | $n$ | $\text{Re}(M\omega_{\text{seed}})$ | $\text{Im}(M\omega_{\text{seed}})$ |
|--------|--------|-----|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| scalar | 2      | 0   | 0.483643872211                     | -0.096758775978                    |
| scalar | 2      | 1   | 0.463850579020                     | -0.295603936988                    |
| scalar | 2      | 2   | 0.430544                           | -0.508558                          |
| scalar | 3      | 0   | 0.675366                           | -0.096500                          |
| scalar | 3      | 1   | 0.660671                           | -0.292285                          |
| scalar | 3      | 2   | 0.633626                           | -0.496008                          |
| scalar | 4      | 0   | 0.867416                           | -0.096392                          |
| scalar | 4      | 1   | 0.855808                           | -0.290876                          |
| scalar | 4      | 2   | 0.833692                           | -0.490325                          |
| axial  | 2      | 0   | 0.373671680                        | -0.088962320                       |
| axial  | 2      | 1   | 0.346710996                        | -0.273914876                       |
| axial  | 2      | 2   | 0.301053454                        | -0.478276983                       |
| axial  | 3      | 0   | 0.599443288                        | -0.092703048                       |
| axial  | 3      | 1   | 0.582643804                        | -0.281298113                       |
| axial  | 3      | 2   | 0.551684837                        | -0.479092791                       |
| axial  | 4      | 0   | 0.809178378                        | -0.094163961                       |
| axial  | 4      | 1   | 0.796631                           | -0.284334                          |
| axial  | 4      | 2   | 0.772695                           | -0.479900                          |

**Table 11** Literature tracking targets used to identify the Schwarzschild branches. The scalar  $\ell = 2, n = 0$  value is pinned to Table I of Cavalcante and da Cunha [34]; the remaining branch targets are drawn from the Schwarzschild tabulations reviewed by Berti, Cardoso, and Starinets [9]. Rounded entries identify branches and are not treated as high-precision accuracy standards.

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**Competing interests.** The author declares no competing interests.

**Data availability.** The numerical data generated in this study, including catalogue rows, spectroscopy diagnostics, and scalar pseudospectrum grids, are available from the accompanying code repository and supplementary output files at <https://github.com/adoolomani2026/ks-qnm-spectral-residual-workflow>.

**Code availability.** The code used to generate the spectral results, Leaver validation, catalogue tables, pseudospectrum diagnostics, and figures is available from the accompanying repository at <https://github.com/adoolomani2026/ks-qnm-spectral-residual-workflow>.

**Author contribution.** Adel H. Al-Yoorby conceived the study, developed the numerical implementation, generated and analyzed the data, prepared the figures and tables, and wrote the manuscript.

**Ethics approval.** Not applicable.

**Consent to participate.** Not applicable.

**Consent for publication.** Not applicable.

**Use of AI tools.** OpenAI Codex with model identifier gpt-5.6-sol, as recorded in the

relevant session metadata, was used during June–July 2026 for code generation, debugging, and refactoring; numerical-analysis scripting; algebraic cross-checks; literature discovery; manuscript drafting and revision; and formatting. The author executed the calculations, checked cited claims against the primary sources, reviewed the derivations and numerical outputs, and takes responsibility for the final content.

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